

WHITFIELD'S OINTMENT

VIWHI02-var (MY)

DESCRIPTION

Tint yellow ointment.

COMPOSITION

Benzoic acid 6% w/w
Salicylic acid 3% w/w

PHARMACODYNAMICS

Salicylic Acid

Salicylic acid facilitates desquamation by solubilizing the intercellular cement that binds scales in the stratum corneum, thereby loosening the keratin. This keratolytic effect may provide an antifungal action because removal of the stratum corneum suppresses fungal growth; it also aids in the penetration of other antifungal agents. Salicylic acid also has a mild antiseptic action.

Benzoic acid

Whitfield's ointment combines the fungistatic action of benzoate with the keratolytic action of salicylate. The addition of salicylic acid to benzoic acid results in a very effective keratolytic preparation that is effective in a variety of skin diseases associated with hyperkeratosis.

The combination is used mainly in the treatment of tinea pedis. Since benzoic acid is only fungistatic, eradication of the infection occurs only after the infected stratum corneum is shed. The salicylic acid accelerates the desquamation.

PHARMACOKINETIC

Absorption

Salicylic acid can be absorbed through the skin.

INDICATIONS

For the treatment of fungal infections of the skin.

WARNINGS AND PRECAUTIONS

- It should be used with care on large areas of skin.
- Do not apply to broken or inflamed skin.

- Prolonged use should be avoided.
- Discontinue therapy if excessive dryness or irritation of the skin occurs.

MAIN SIDE/ADVERSE EFFECTS

Allergic reactions and dermatitis may occur occasionally.

OVERDOSE AND TREATMENT

Clinical features

- Hyperventilation, hyperthermia and sweating
- Epigastric pain and vomiting
- Dehydration
- Respiratory alkalosis, metabolic acidosis
- Pulmonary oedema (non-cardiogenic)
- Rarely coma

Treatment

- Emesis or gastric lavage, if indicated (in adults up to 24 hours post ingestion)
- Correct electrolyte and metabolic acidosis

DOSAGE AND ADMINISTRATION

Apply a thin film over the affected area, 2 or 3 times a day.

Note: The information given here is limited. For further information, consult your doctor or pharmacist.

Storage: Store below 30 °C.

Presentation/Packing: Ointment 15 g, 450 g and 500 g.
(Not all presentation available locally)

Product Registration Holder /
Manufactured by: HOVID Bhd.
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